

# Retention & deletion

Draft for review. See README.md .

## Principle

Sprint data is kept only as long as needed for the engagement and the agreed follow-up, then erased. The platform has working **backup** and **erasure** capabilities (below), so this policy describes real mechanisms, not intentions.

## Retention schedule (controller to set the exact periods)

| Data                                                   | Default retention                                      | Trigger to delete                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Sprint records (scores, concepts, prototypes, readout) | Engagement + <b>[12] months</b> for follow-up advisory | End of retention period, or on controller request |
| AI-interview transcripts & uploaded documents          | Engagement + <b>[3] months</b>                         | End of period, or on request                      |
| Test-panel feedback (first name, age, quotes, scores)  | <b>[3] months</b> after the sprint                     | End of period                                     |
| Backups (our snapshots)                                | <b>[90] days</b> , rolling                             | Auto-expire                                       |

These are starting defaults — the **controller decides** the periods in the DPA.

## How erasure actually works

1 **Our database (Turso, EU).** `npm run delete-sprint <sprintId> --apply`

permanently deletes the sprint and every attached row (participants, assessments, scores, documents, concepts, feedback) across all tables. Run a dry-run first (omit `--apply` ) to see exactly what will go.

1 **Our backups.** Snapshots are local JSON files ( `npm run backup` ); purge the relevant file(s) when honouring an erasure request, or let them roll off the 90-day window.

1 **Sub-processor copies — age out automatically:**

**Anthropic:** API inputs/outputs auto-deleted within **30 days** (no action needed; not retrievable by us in the meantime).

**Vercel:** backups roll off within **30 days**.

**Turso:** deleting the data above removes it from the live database; deleting a database also deletes its backups.

So a data-subject erasure request is satisfied by: delete from our DB now → purge the relevant backup → confirm sub-processor copies age out within 30 days. **Maximum time to full erasure across all systems: 30 days** (bounded by the Anthropic/Vercel windows), immediate in our own store.

## Data-subject requests

Forward any request received directly to the **controller** (it owns the relationship and the legal basis). On the controller's instruction, action it using the mechanisms above and confirm completion in writing.

### Caveat on `claude-opus-4-8`

The current AI model mandates a 30-day Anthropic-side retention and cannot run zero-retention (see `01_...`). So "immediate and total erasure everywhere" is not truthful while data is within that 30-day window — state the **30-day bound** honestly. If a client requires faster guaranteed erasure at the AI layer, that is part of the EU-residency / model decision in `09_open-items-and-decisions.md` .